MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION April 2026

SECOND SEMESTER

MG2DSCSDV100 - EDITING PRINCIPLES

Duration: 2 Hours Maximum Marks: 70

SCHEME FOR VALUATION

Part A

Short Answer

Answer any 10, 2 marks each

1. **What is a high-angle shot? [U] / [CO1]**
   - A shot taken from above the subject, looking downward
   - It makes the subject appear smaller or less powerful
   - Often used to show vulnerability or weakness
   - Creates a sense of dominance from viewer perspective
2. **How can time expansion be used to heighten drama? [An] / [CO2]**
   - Time expansion slows down action to prolong key moments
   - Allows audience to observe emotional details clearly
   - Builds tension by delaying outcome of events
   - Commonly used in slow-motion dramatic sequences
3. **Describe the shot-reverse shot technique. [U] / [CO3]**
   - Alternates between two characters during a conversation
   - Maintains spatial continuity and screen direction
   - Helps audience follow dialogue interactions easily
   - Widely used in interviews and dialogue scenes
4. **What is a typical feature of a metric montage? [U] / [CO4]**
   - Shots are cut based on equal time duration
   - Does not consider content within each shot
   - Creates mechanical rhythm and visual tension
   - Often used in experimental editing styles
5. **Explain the use of a fade-in transition. [U] / [CO3]**
   - Image gradually appears from a black screen
   - Used to introduce a new scene or beginning
   - Creates smooth and gentle visual transition
   - Suggests passage of time or narrative start
6. **Describe the function of a reverse shot. [U] / [CO1]**
   - Shows the opposite angle of the previous shot
   - Maintains continuity between interacting characters
   - Helps establish spatial relationship within a scene
   - Commonly used in conversational sequences
7. **What is the impact of fast-paced editing on viewers? [An] / [CO2]**
   - Creates excitement and high-energy viewing experience
   - Increases tension during action and chase sequences
   - Keeps audience attention actively engaged
   - May create confusion if used excessively

8. **What is an eyeline match in editing? [U] / [CO3]**
    - A cut that follows the character's line of sight
    - Shows what the character is looking at
    - Maintains logical continuity between consecutive shots
    - Helps audience understand spatial relationships
9. **What characterizes a rhythmic montage? [U] / [CO4]**
    - Editing based on movement within individual shots
    - Shot length varies according to visual rhythm
    - Creates flow and harmony in the sequence
    - Considers internal composition of each shot
10. **Define the 180-degree rule in film editing. [U] / [CO3]**
    - An imaginary axis that should not be crossed
    - Maintains consistent screen direction of characters
    - Prevents confusion in spatial orientation
    - Ensures continuity in dialogue scenes
11. **What is the Soviet montage theory? [U] / [CO4]**
    - A theory where meaning is created through editing
    - Developed by filmmakers like Sergei Eisenstein
    - Juxtaposition of shots produces new ideas
    - Focuses on emotional and intellectual impact
12. **How does a cutaway shot function in editing? [U] / [CO3]**
    - Cuts away from main action to a related detail
    - Provides additional information to the audience
    - Helps avoid jump cuts in editing
    - Adds context or reaction within the scene

[2x10 = 20]

Part B

One Paragraph Answer

Answer any 6, 5 marks each

13. **Explain the consequences of poor spatial continuity in editing. [U] / [CO3]**
    - Creates confusion about positions of characters and objects
    - Breaks illusion of continuous cinematic space
    - Disrupts audience immersion in narrative flow
    - Leads to misinterpretation of visual actions
    - Reduces clarity and coherence of storytelling
    - Makes transitions appear unnatural and abrupt
14. **Discuss the role of montage in modern filmmaking. [U] / [CO4]**
    - Montage helps compress time and narrative events effectively
    - Creates meaning through juxtaposition of different shots
    - Enhances emotional and intellectual viewer response
    - Widely used in songs, trailers, and action sequences
    - Supports symbolic and thematic storytelling approaches
15. **Discuss the narrative importance of focus shift in storytelling. [U] / [CO1]**
    - Focus shift directs viewer attention within a single frame
    - Highlights important elements without cutting shots
    - Creates depth and layered visual composition

- Reveals new information gradually to audience
- Enhances dramatic tension within scenes

16. **How does rhythm in music influence editing process? [An] / [CO2]**
    - Editing often follows tempo and beats of music
    - Creates synchronization between audio and visuals
    - Enhances emotional engagement of the audience
    - Determines pace of cuts and transitions
    - Maintains smooth flow and continuity in sequences
17. **How cross cutting technique can enhance action editing. [U] / [CO3]**
    - Cross cutting shows parallel actions happening simultaneously
    - Builds suspense by alternating between scenes
    - Delays resolution to increase dramatic tension
    - Enhances pace and excitement of sequences
    - Connects different narrative spaces effectively
18. **Explain wide shot vs close-up with example. [U] / [CO1]**
    - Wide shot shows environment and character placement clearly
    - Helps establish location and spatial relationships
    - Close-up focuses on facial expressions and emotions
    - Highlights psychological state of characters
    - Wide shot used for establishing scenes
    - Close-up used for emotional emphasis
19. **Write a brief note about J cut and L cut. [U] / [CO3]**
    - J cut introduces next scene audio before visual change
    - L cut continues previous audio into next visual shot
    - Both techniques create smooth audio-visual transitions
    - Help maintain continuity across scenes
    - Enhance narrative flow without abrupt cuts
20. **Explain how the Kuleshov effect can manipulate audience perception. [U] / [CO4]**
    - Meaning is created by combining two consecutive shots
    - Same expression suggests different emotions in context
    - Audience interprets meaning based on sequence
    - Demonstrates power of editing over performance
    - Enhances emotional engagement through juxtaposition
21. **Explain the importance of emotion in editing (Walter Murch). [U] / [CO3]**
    - Emotion is primary factor guiding editing decisions
    - Cuts should serve emotional truth of the scene
    - Technical perfection is secondary to emotional impact
    - Helps audience connect deeply with characters
    - Guides rhythm and pacing of sequences
    - Ensures engaging and meaningful storytelling

[5x6=30]

Part C

Short Essay

Answer any 2, 10 marks each

22. **Evaluate the use of intellectual montage in film. [U] / [CO4]**
    - Intellectual montage creates meaning through conceptual editing

- Uses contrast between shots to generate new ideas
- Encourages audience to interpret deeper meanings
- Often used for political or philosophical themes
- Enhances depth of cinematic storytelling
- Example: symbolic sequences in Eisenstein films
- Shows editing as tool for intellectual engagement
- Helps convey abstract ideas visually
- Widely used in experimental cinema
- Strengthens thematic communication in films

23. **Analyze the importance of Eye Trace in editing. [U] / [CO3]**
    - Eye trace guides viewer attention across successive shots
    - Maintains visual continuity between different frames
    - Ensures smooth transition of focus points
    - Reduces confusion in complex visual sequences
    - Helps control audience perception effectively
    - Supports storytelling through visual direction
    - Enhances clarity and engagement of narrative
    - Example: matching gaze direction across cuts
    - Improves overall viewing experience
    - Essential in professional editing practice
24. **Discuss importance of natural rhythms in storytelling. [An] / [CO2]**
    - Natural rhythms reflect real-life pacing of actions
    - Helps create believable and relatable sequences
    - Editing aligns with emotional flow of scenes
    - Avoids mechanical and artificial cutting patterns
    - Supports organic development of narrative events
    - Enhances audience immersion in the story
    - Balances fast and slow moments effectively
    - Used in dialogue and dramatic scenes
    - Improves storytelling authenticity and impact

[10x2=20]